

pany, we are a very strong team. We have solid teams across Ola, Ola Electric, Ola Cell. My and Ola's journey is to build the future here for India and ourselves, and it is not going to be an easy journey. That's my philosophy.

We are scaling up our ride-hailing business. It will see a focus on electrification. There have been post-Covid-19 challenges of customer experience because of lower supply, so we are solving that aggressively. My attention has been on both businesses. My passion is my work.

Q: What is the next step for ride-hailing?

A: The future of ride-hailing is going to be electric and it benefits everybody in the ecosystem—the consumer, society because it is green, but most importantly [it] benefits the driver because it's cheaper to operate an electric car and the driver can earn more money. As a result, more drivers will be pulled into the industry and the drivers will be more incentivised and will be able to deliver a better customer experience. Our big focus now

“TVS is a credible company. It is good to have competition. My vision for the Indian industry is to be world leaders in this electrification journey. And it can't just be Ola”

is on electrification. We announced a plan a few months ago about adding electric cars. You will see some major announcements in due course.

Q: What is your fund-raising plan at Ola Electric?

A: We are investing aggressively and at the right time we will raise more capital. As of now, our balance sheet is very strong.

Q: Do you think battery swapping is the solution or is it creating charging stations?

A: All these questions are part of the debate we need to get through, as a part of the stakeholder group, to understand the paradigm of the future of EVs in India. Is it hydrogen or lithium, is it swapping or charging stations, etc.? The anxiety around charging comes from an old mindset—what if the charge of the vehicle gets over? Even with countries where there is high EV adoption, it's not that they have an equal number of charging stations. We are now expanding our charging network but we have almost 200,000 electric vehicles already on roads [and customers] have been charging them at home.

Q: Some EV players are under the government's lens for misusing the FAME subsidy...

A: Some players did not do the right thing in spirit as many people were getting things from China; from Day One we have manufactured everything in India—in our factories mostly, and through Indian suppliers. People often say to me, 'Why are you making everything?' So, my thing is, if you are getting things from China, then it should have its own repercussions. We should create the Indian ecosystem. But now we are thinking beyond FAME. We are building our cost structures, our supply chain, scale... My view is FAME should fade out once EV penetration is 10 per cent, which will happen this year.

Q: What will your car be called?

A: [We] have not given it a name yet.

Q: Where do you see Ola as an ecosystem by 2025 or 2026?

A: As a group, our ambition is to be significantly impactful in a few major technology themes of our era. One technology theme is consumer tech, where we are one of the leading companies in India through ride-hailing and AI. The second technology theme is electrification, converting our transportation to clean [energy]. And the third technology theme is new energy. And in these three technologies, we will be the leaders here. That's our ambition in two to three years. Today, we are already leaders in different ways across these three themes. And you will see us double down and become even stronger leaders because we are building technology.

Many people ask me sometimes that technology also changes fast. Isn't it a risk that I am taking? That question is from a mindset of consumption of technology, not creation of technology. When you are creating technology, you do your own generational advancements. You are at the cutting edge, so that's how big technology companies have been built. They have not been built by consuming technologies—they have created the road map of technology and influenced it and taken the right strategic calls in technology. That's what we are doing. When it comes to specifically electric, our goal has been for two-wheelers to be fully electric in India by 2025-end. I still stand by that and I feel optimistic that the Indian industry will hit that [figure]. In three years, we can make all two-wheeler vehicles sold in India electric.

Our car will be out next year. We will be building a few cars over the course of the next three to four years. We aim to be leaders in that space. Today, all the four-wheeler EVs that exist in India are largely ICE vehicle platforms converted into EVs, which are not efficient. And ours will be a greenfield EV platform, riding on technology. **BT**

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